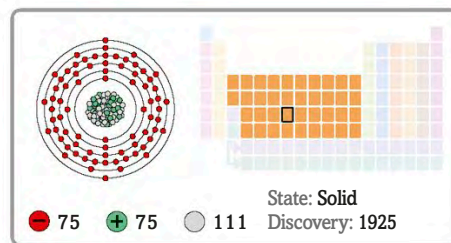


75
Re

Rhenium



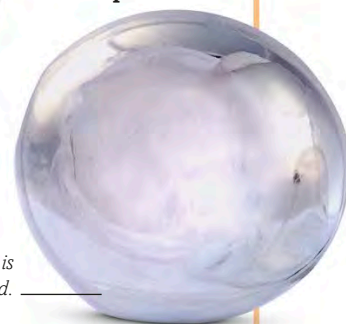
Forms



Molybdenite

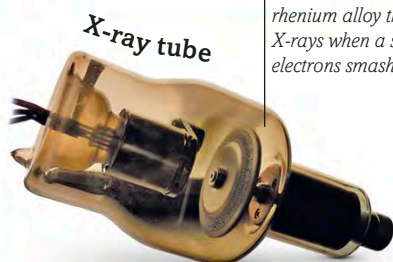
This ore contains molybdenum and small amounts of rhenium.

Pure rhenium pellet



Pure rhenium is denser than gold.

Uses



X-ray tube

These tubes contain a rhenium alloy that produces X-rays when a stream of electrons smashes into it.

Rhenium has the **highest boiling point** of any element.



F-22 Raptor fighter plane

This plane has jet engines containing a heat-proof rhenium alloy.

Rhenium is very rare in nature: only one atom out of every billion in Earth's crust is a rhenium atom. Discovered in Germany in 1925, and named after the Rhine river – it was the last stable, non-radioactive element to be found. Rhenium has a very high melting

point, and can stay solid at extreme temperatures. This allows alloys made of this element to be used in very hot conditions, such as those inside the tubes of **X-ray machines**, as well as those in the exhaust nozzles of rockets and the jet engines of **fighter planes**.